



Figure 3: The stamp effect in GIMP

pronounced by eliminating dull and imperfect lightning. What are you waiting for? Give it a try :-)

The Sin City effect

With reference to what we learnt in the fifth assignment in this series on the GIMP, this effect is in its own league and has nothing to do with any selection tool. The name 'isolation' is a bit odd for this effect since we are not actually extracting any part, in any way. To be precise, this tool makes a part appear more highlighted, like in the Sin City movie.

Although the Sin City effect is a little difficult and complex, the path is the same. Grab any image and open it (in the GIMP, of course!). For this tutorial, use objects like a car, truck or any thing big that can be highlighted.

Step 1 Duplicate the background layer by right clicking and selecting 'Duplicate Layer'.

Step 2 Rename the layer to 'Mask Layer' by right clicking and selecting 'Edit Layer Attributes'.

Step 3 Select the newly created layer and desaturate the layer from **Colors→Desaturate**, with 'Lightness' as the desaturation mode.

Once you have desaturated the cloned layer, it's time to get moving with the mask.

Step 4 Add a mask to the layer. Right click the 'Mask Layer' and add a white mask (full opacity).

Notice that any drawing or editing done from now on appends to the Mask Layer.

Step 5 Grab any brush and, with black as the FG colour, apply the brush to the part that you want to isolate.

Zoom in, and increase/decrease the brush radius in order to achieve a perfect effect with no distortion or abnormalities. Now apply the brush only to the object you want to isolate/colour from the desaturated background.

If you erred and coloured the outer periphery, then you can easily undo it by pressing **Ctrl+z** or change the foreground colour to white and use the paintbrush in the undesired area. White restores and black erases the portion when applied in the mask.

Another cool effect completed in a few steps!

The stamp/postcard effect

I always had an affinity towards stamps and postcards. Their designs and the zigzag edges

around stamps have always attracted me. Ever since I laid my hands on the GIMP, this was the effect I tried to come up with.

For the stamp effect, we will be eyeing the Quick Mask tool. You can activate Quick Mask from **Select→Quick Mask**.

So, let's get started. As always, open an image, select the rectangle selection from the toolbox and create a big selection.

Step 1 Toggle Quick Mask by pressing **Shift+q**.

Step 2 Navigate to **Distorts→Ripple**, with Period, Amplitude and Phase shift settings as 15, 3, 0, respectively. Apply the effect, both horizontally and vertically, one by one.

Step 3 Undo the 'Quick Mask' by pressing **Shift+q**. Notice that as soon as you remove the Quick Mask, the GIMP frames the selection into an active selection.

Thus, from here, you can easily make a postcard or stamp. Just copy and paste in a new template. Change the transition to 'permanent'.

Once done, right click on the new layer and select Alpha to Selection. Navigate to **Select→Borders** and, with 1 as radius, apply the border. That's it — just add the black colour to the border! Add a few other effects here and there if you want to and you will have completed the stamp effect as well.

Phew! That sums up the sixth instalment in our series on the GIMP. In the next tutorial, we will unravel the wallpaper using the Path Tool. This is one of the most versatile effects that gels with various shapes and is used often by many graphic giants. Till then, stay tuned and have fun GIMPing. 

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